

## Defending with the Back 4 - Zonal Defense

PLAYER ACTIONS:

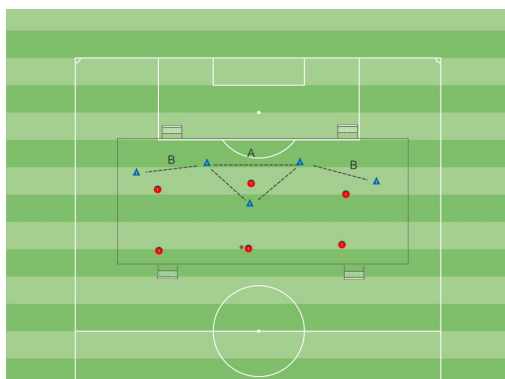
KEY QUALITIES:

Ryan Heflin

AGE: U13 / U19 / 18 players

Defending

DURATION: 90 min



### 6 v 5 Defending

OBJECTIVE: Back 4 - Compact, Move as a Unit

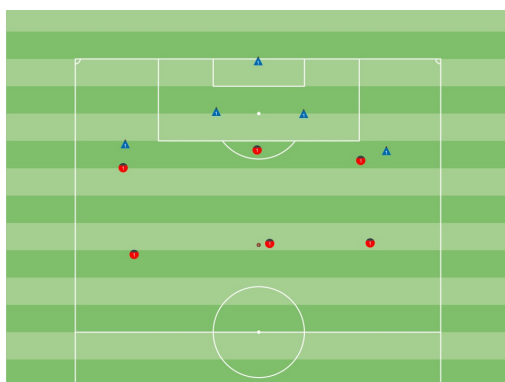
ORGANIZATION: • Mark out a 25x50m pitch. • Place 2 mini-goals an equal distance apart along both lengths of the grid. Set up with a back 4 and a 6. Defend 6 players in a 3-3 attempting to split lines. Attacking team limited to 3 touches. Defending team attempts 1 pass and clear to one of the two goals

KEY WORDS:

GUIDED QUESTIONS:

ANSWERS:

NOTES: High Intensity Rotations. Change where the ball starts to force defense to adjust.



### 6 v 4 plus GK

OBJECTIVE: Larger Space to Defend - Stay Compact and prevent splits

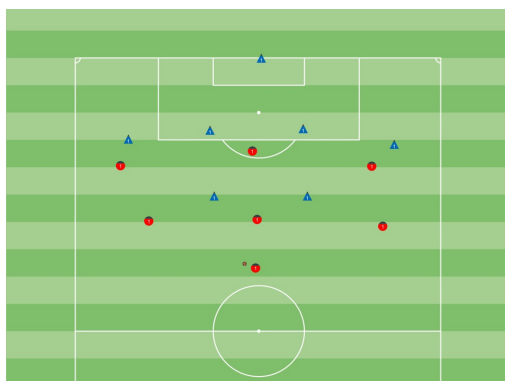
ORGANIZATION: Half Field with Full Size Goal. Back 4 as usual, no covering DM. Back 4 against 3-3, covering the whole field.

KEY WORDS:

GUIDED QUESTIONS:

ANSWERS:

NOTES:



### 7 v 6 and GK

OBJECTIVE: Add in Defensive Responsibilities of the Double Pivot

ORGANIZATION: Use half of the pitch and a full-size goal. Divide the players into 2 teams: 7 attackers and 6 defenders with a goalkeeper. The attacking team set up in a 5-2 formation (2 wing-backs, 3 midfielders and 2 strikers). The defending team adopt a 4-2 formation (a back 4 and 2 midfielders). The attacking team seek to work the ball into the penalty area

KEY WORDS:

GUIDED QUESTIONS:

ANSWERS:

NOTES: